

HOUSE No. 2020

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Steven Ultrino

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to rental protections for elderly, disabled and low-to-middle income tenants.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Steven Ultrino</i>	<i>33rd Middlesex</i>	<i>1/13/2025</i>
<i>Bud L. Williams</i>	<i>11th Hampden</i>	<i>3/24/2025</i>
<i>James C. Arena-DeRosa</i>	<i>8th Middlesex</i>	<i>3/28/2025</i>
<i>Carmin Lawrence Gentile</i>	<i>13th Middlesex</i>	<i>3/28/2025</i>
<i>James B. Eldridge</i>	<i>Middlesex and Worcester</i>	<i>7/24/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 2020

By Representative Ultrino of Malden, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 2020) of Steven Ultrino relative to rental protections for elderly, disabled and low-to-middle income tenants. The Judiciary.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to rental protections for elderly, disabled and low-to-middle income tenants.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. Chapter 186 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2020 Official Edition,
2 is hereby amended by adding the following section:-

3 Section 31. (a) As used in this section, the word “tenant” shall mean a person who has
4 entered into an oral or written lease or rental agreement for residential property located in the
5 commonwealth who is: (i) 65 years of age or older, (ii) a person with a disability as defined in 42
6 U.S.C. § 12102 or (iii) a person with income at or below 80 percent of the area median income as
7 determined by the United States Department of Housing and Urban Development.

8 (b) A tenant may terminate a rental agreement or tenancy upon written notification to the
9 property owner that the tenant applied for and is accepted for admission to housing for the
10 elderly, persons with disabilities or persons of low to moderate income, including, but not
11 limited to: (1) a nursing home licensed pursuant to section 71 of chapter 111; (2) an assisted
12 living residence certified pursuant to section 3 of chapter 19D; (3) elderly housing, as defined in

section 1 of said chapter 19D; (4) a public housing development, as defined in section 32B of chapter 121B; (5) publicly-assisted housing, as defined in section 1 of chapter 40T; (6) age restricted housing for persons 55 years of age and over; and (7) low or moderate income housing, as defined in section 20 of chapter 40B; provided, that the notification is made not less than 30 days prior to the date of termination of the rental agreement or tenancy. A tenant who provides written notification to the property owner not less than 30 days prior to the date of termination of the rental agreement or tenancy shall not be subject to any penalty for such termination or liability for the remaining term of the rental agreement or tenancy.

(c) A property owner shall not refuse to enter into a rental agreement, nor shall a housing subsidy provider deny assistance, based on an applicant having terminated a rental agreement pursuant to subsection (b).

(d) A waiver of subsection (b) in any lease or other rental agreement, except as otherwise provided by law shall be void and unenforceable.

(e) The superior court, housing court, district court and Boston municipal court shall have jurisdiction in equity to restrain violations of subsections (b) through (d), inclusive.

(f) The department of housing and community development shall promulgate rules and regulations to implement and carry out this section, including defining additional types of housing for the elderly, persons with disabilities or persons of low to moderate income for which a tenancy may be terminated pursuant to subsection (b).